

Figure 5: VM-creation5

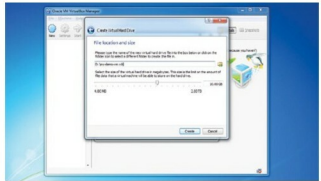


Figure 7: VM-creation7

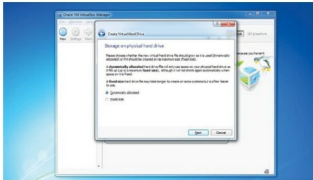


Figure 6: VM-creation6

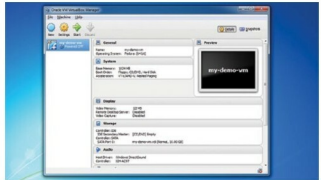


Figure 8: VM-creation8

A dynamically allocated disk allows maximum use of the host's disk space and prevents wastage of unused disk space within the VM but, on the other hand, since disk space is being allocated dynamically, the I/O operations on the VM take a hit. The decision on which of the two options to choose lies entirely with the user and the purpose the VM is being created for.

For our example, I will go with the default option, *Dynamically allocated*.

6. The next dialogue box (Figure 7) will allow you to select the virtual hard disk size, its name and also the file system location where the disk image is to be created. All choices available in the dialogue box will have their default values, but I would personally advise users to alter at least the location for disk image creation. Let's look at all the options.

- f. **Virtual hard disk driver location:** By default, this location is `/user/Home/Virtual/` but I would personally suggest that you keep to a different drive so that you can maintain a better and separate track of the virtual disk drives you have created. Also, if anything nasty happens to the VM, it will not have any effect on your `C` or `User` directory.
- g. **Size of the virtual disk drive:** Users can select the desired size for the virtual disk drive.

Once everything is configured as per desired values, you can click **Create** to actually create the disk drive image and the VM itself.

7. Our VM is now created and the VirtualBox home page will

list it (Figure 8) along with the details of its basic properties.

8. It's now time to start using our VM. But wait! We haven't installed any operating system on it.
9. In the VM context, installing an OS is considered to be an operation on the VM rather than a part of the VM creation process.

Configuring a VM

In this section, we will look at how we can adjust the various properties of our VM, add or remove hardware resources, and install an operating system. We will also look at how to start using a VM as an independent OS.

1. **Configuring VM properties:** If you think that you would like to change some properties or resources allocated to the VM that were missed out during VM creation, go to the VirtualBox main page and select the 'Settings' option (Figure 9) to access all VM properties and change them, as desired. A point to note here is that you will not be able to change each and every value, but those restrictions are self-explanatory.
2. **Installing an OS on the VM:** It's now time to install the operating system on the VM. Let's look at the process in the following steps.
 - a. First and foremost, we need an installation source (DVD/network boot location). For this demo I am using the DVD method and leaving the network boot for readers to try out.
 - b. To associate a DVD with the VM, go to the VirtualBox main page and click on *Settings*.